JavaScript is disabled on your browser.

compact1, compact2, compact3

java.lang

Class ExceptionInInitializerError

java.lang.Object
  java.lang.Throwable
    java.lang.Error
      java.lang.LinkageError
        java.lang.ExceptionInInitializerError

All Implemented Interfaces:

Serializable

```
public class ExceptionInInitializerError
extends LinkageError
```

Signals that an unexpected exception has occurred in a static initializer. An `ExceptionInInitializerError` is thrown to indicate that an exception occurred during evaluation of a static initializer or the initializer for a static variable.

As of release 1.4, this exception has been retrofitted to conform to the general purpose exception-chaining mechanism. The "saved throwable object" that may be provided at construction time and accessed via the `getException()` method is now known as the *cause*, and may be accessed via the `Throwable.getCause()` method, as well as the aforementioned "legacy method."

Since:

JDK1.1

See Also:

Serialized Form

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Constructor	Description
`ExceptionInInitializerError()`	Constructs an `ExceptionInInitializerError` with `null` as its detail message string and with no saved throwable object.
`ExceptionInInitializerError(String s)`	Constructs an ExceptionInInitializerError with the specified detail message string.
`ExceptionInInitializerError(Throwable thrown)`	Constructs a new `ExceptionInInitializerError` class by saving a reference to the `Throwable` object thrown for later retrieval by the **`getException()`** method.

Method Summary

Concrete Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
`Throwable`	`getCause()`	Returns the cause of this error (the exception that occurred during a static initialization that caused this error to be created).
`Throwable`	`getException()`	Returns the exception that occurred during a static initialization that caused this error to be created.

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Throwable

`addSuppressed`, `fillInStackTrace`, `getLocalizedMessage`, `getMessage`, `getStackTrace`, `getSuppressed`, `initCause`, `printStackTrace`, `printStackTrace`, `printStackTrace`, `setStackTrace`, `toString`

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Object

`clone`, `equals`, `finalize`, `getClass`, `hashCode`, `notify`, `notifyAll`, `wait`, `wait`, `wait`

Constructor Detail

ExceptionInInitializerError

```
public ExceptionInInitializerError()
```

Constructs an `ExceptionInInitializerError` with `null` as its detail message string and with no saved throwable object. A detail message is a String that describes this particular exception.

ExceptionInInitializerError

```
public ExceptionInInitializerError(Throwable thrown)
```

Constructs a new `ExceptionInInitializerError` class by saving a reference to the `Throwable` object thrown for later retrieval by the `getException()` method. The detail message string is set to `null`.

Parameters:

`thrown - The exception thrown`

ExceptionInInitializerError

```
public ExceptionInInitializerError(String s)
```

Constructs an ExceptionInInitializerError with the specified detail message string. A detail message is a String that describes this particular exception. The detail message string is saved for later retrieval by the `Throwable.getMessage()` method. There is no saved throwable object.

Parameters:

`s - the detail message`

Method Detail

getException

```
public Throwable getException()
```

Returns the exception that occurred during a static initialization that caused this error to be created.

This method predates the general-purpose exception chaining facility. The `Throwable.getCause()` method is now the preferred means of obtaining this information.

Returns:

`the saved throwable object of this ExceptionInInitializerError, or null if this ExceptionInInitializerError has no saved throwable object.`

getCause

```
public Throwable getCause()
```

Returns the cause of this error (the exception that occurred during a static initialization that caused this error to be created).

Overrides:

`getCause` in class `Throwable`

Returns:

`the cause of this error or null if the cause is nonexistent or unknown.`

Since:

`1.4`

Submit a bug or feature

For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.

Copyright © 1993, 2026, Oracle and/or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Use is subject to license terms. Also see the documentation redistribution policy.

Scripting on this page tracks web page traffic, but does not change the content in any way.